

CLAUDE COMMUNITY KENYA

Claude Conversations, Nairobi

Event report

Saturday 29 August 2026, Blockchain Centre NBO

Prepared by Peter Kibet, Claude Code Ambassador, Kenya

VERSION 5, 2 SEPTEMBER 2026

These minutes were taken from the room's own recording, with attendees named by role only.

Summary

About 15 people spent Saturday afternoon at Blockchain Centre working the three questions from the Claude Conversations kit as one table, in turns. A plan built for 50 at eight tables ran as a single conversation, so no cards went on a wall and no vote was held.

Four things kept coming back. Frontier AI is priced for another market: KES 27,000 a month for a Max plan against a gazetted Nairobi minimum wage of KES 18,047. The access gap for Kenyan children is opening, and one attendee has already built an offline tutor with a teacher in the loop. Kenyan data is missing from the models, and nobody could say who would own it once captured. The first rung of work is going, from junior developer hiring to the nurse whose patients arrive with an app's verdict.

The findings produced three fixed problems for Wednesday's Impact Lab and two asks for Anthropic's Policy team.

Event at a glance

ITEM	DETAIL
Date	Saturday 29 August 2026
Venue	Blockchain Centre NBO, Argwings Kodhek Road, Nairobi
Host	Peter Kibet, Claude Code Ambassador for Kenya
Format as planned	7 to 8 tables of 6 to 8, one prompt per table, read-outs, cards on the wall, dot vote, 2:00 to 5:00 PM
Format as run	One table, all three prompts in turn, round-robin, roughly 3:45 to 5:30 PM
Attendance	About 15, against a plan for 50
Prompts from the kit	1. What does AI mean for my job? 2. What is AI doing to me, my kids, my community? 3. Who decides the rules?
Feeds	Impact Lab: AI Mashinani 02, Wednesday 2 September 2026, Hackhouse Africa

Who was in the room

The room was mixed in the way the format asks for, even at 15: a nurse; a farmer from Sultan Hamud now building a coffee-traceability platform; a specialist working in a One Health context; a builder of small language models for edge devices, who brought a working Raspberry Pi prototype; staff from

two banks; developers, a data-validation analyst and a UX designer; a former senior software engineer now in DevRel; someone who runs two communities for young people with disabilities; a student. The host uses Claude daily and runs his own farm-management product, MkulimaOS.

What the room said

What does AI mean for my job

The nurse opened. Patients now arrive having described their symptoms to an app overnight and come to the clinic with a conclusion rather than a question. An app can tell someone “it has told me I have cancer”, and she cannot dismiss that, but “this person is just coming with what they’ve read online all night.” Her ask was for a way of narrowing the information between the app and the consultation.

The DevRel speaker said that three years ago “I knew that software engineers were going to be the first attack.” Hiring for software developers “has dropped drastically” and companies now want AI-native builders. The UX designer read the same moment as opportunity: “It tells me to pivot fast, super, super fast.” The displacement cases the room agreed on were Chegg, whose traffic collapsed once students could ask an AI, and prompt engineering, a job title that was over as fast as it began “because it was a service.”

Then the longest thread of the afternoon. An attendee asked the host whether his spending had gone up: “I’d brand him as luxury AI.” The host answered with his own ledger: the Max plan with tax is around KES 27,000 a month, “a lot, honestly,” and it built MkulimaOS for less than the engineers he would otherwise have hired. The ask came from the room: “if you’re still talking to Anthropic, at least tell them to adjust for purchasing power,” with the tail “they charge us as if we’re living in California.”

AI, me, kids, community

A participant who builds farming software asked the farmer what AI could do farm to market. The answer was specific: an agentic system that walks a farmer “from the idea of what to farm, how to farm it, what to purchase, all the way to selling.” Fancy dashboards are close to useless for farmers who are not formally educated; something they can talk to and direct would work.

On children the room agreed without dissent that the gap is opening: “there is also a 9 year old somewhere who is still counting sticks,” set against a nine-year-old elsewhere building an agent, both expected to compete in the same world for the same resources. One speaker located the cause in policy rather than in AI: “it’s more like an infrastructural problem.” The edge-models builder described the prototype that answers part of this: a Raspberry Pi serving its own Wi-Fi with no backhaul, a small model over CBC curriculum content and government scheme information, and a teacher curating what students see. “It doesn’t need to be powerful, right? Because the scope is narrow.”

On community, the ownership question surfaced. One speaker said African traditions are oral, so there is little for models to train on, and “we’re losing whatever makes us us” to imported popular culture. She then asked: when we solve our own community’s problems, “will we just train the AI so that those solutions will come back and be sold to us as another subscription?”

Several people volunteered that heavy Claude use had made them antisocial, and one had joined the ambassador programme “out of loneliness of using Claude in the house.”

Who decides the rules

Three answers were offered and none won. The first was top-down: “government, because governments make policy, policy affects corporations, corporations make the products,” with company reputation as the only check. The second disagreed outright: “I think the person who decides the rules is the consumer.” Whatever earns money gets built; if a government banned something, someone would build it anyway. The third split it three ways: government first, then the corporation, then the user, whose rule is what they choose to put in.

The round closed on the invisible layer: every model carries “a whole book of instructions ahead of your own instruction” that the user cannot see. The last word was half a joke: “Mr. Dario will make the rules.”

Findings

These are findings, not a ranking. No vote took place.

- 1 Frontier AI is priced for a market this room is not in.**
The host’s bill, KES 27,000 a month for a Max plan with tax, sits against Nairobi’s gazetted minimum wage of KES 18,047. What was contested was the cause, whether Claude is expensive or everything is, and never the fact. This is carried to Anthropic’s Policy team rather than built.
- 2 The access gap for children is opening, and the working design keeps an adult in the loop.**
The Raspberry Pi tutor keeps a teacher between the model and the child: “I wanted to have a human in the loop, which is the teacher.” A one-day team can build the offline software layer with the teacher as the user. Devices and power stay out of scope. This became Track 1.
- 3 Kenyan data is missing from the models, and nobody said who would own it.**
The One Health specialist said Claude is more precise in her domain but that African data is thin because most of it is on paper: “there’s information on our end, but it’s not out there, it’s not accessible.” Consent and revocable ownership are the hard part; a recording interface is easy. This goes to the Policy team with the pricing ask.
- 4 The first rung of work is going, and the nurse’s waiting room shows where it lands.**
Junior hiring has dropped drastically and nobody disputed it. The nurse’s patients hand her a verdict instead of a symptom, so her first job is to reopen the question. The buildable piece is at her end: something that narrows what the patient brings to the consultation without diagnosing. This became Track 3.

How the tracks were decided

The kit's closing step was not run; the time was gone. On the morning of Monday 31 August the host cut three tracks from the findings, one problem per track, so that judges compare execution rather than ambition. Two shapes were dropped before the tracks reached the team: a parent-facing homework explainer, because it would carry a child's identifiable homework into the system, and the farm-to-market agent, because the agent must not act on the farmer's behalf.

Later that day the volunteer team reviewed the tracks. The central objection: "you're saying we are giving them a solution to build rather than a problem." Track 1 as then written specified the exact output, so every team would build the same thing. The counter-position, also in the room: "we need to create problems that will be easy to judge." The team stated a goal for each track apart from its mechanism. Elimu: "to improve the quality of education children get through the plan." Kilimo: "the goal is to give fair value to the farmer." Kazi: "the problem is self-diagnosis."

The host rewrote the tracks on the team's side. The problem and its rules are fixed and binding; the build is open; under each track sits one worked answer so builders can see the scale of thing that fits in a day, marked "one answer, not the answer." The final wording goes to the approved builders before doors open on 2 September, and the blast says in the host's own words that the team "pushed back hard on one thing" and that "they were right."

Impact Lab tracks

Everything except the build is binding.

TRACK 1 Elimu Mwalimu wa Grade 10

PROBLEM A Grade 10 teacher prepares a strand she was never trained for. There is no internet in the room and the textbooks have not arrived.

GOAL The quality of education the children in that class get, not the software.

FIXED RULES The teacher is the user, no child logs in, and no learner's name or work enters the system. Judges ask one question: would a real Grade 10 teacher use this for tomorrow's lesson, offline?

ONE ANSWER, NOT THE ANSWER She picks a strand and a lesson length and gets a 40-minute plan, five questions with a marking scheme and one no-materials activity, as an offline pack. One attendee's Raspberry Pi tutor is the offline lane.

TRACK 2 Kilimo Nitapata?

PROBLEM A registered smallholder cannot tell whether the depot will serve him, what he still lacks, what the bag costs or whether a loan fits, and he would rather ask a phone than travel to an officer.

GOAL Fair value to the farmer, and a wasted trip prevented rather than caused.

FIXED RULES Grounded only in published scheme documents, it cites the document, and it names the missing step. No agronomic advice, no dosage, no payments, no autonomous action. One warning: most agri-tech already tries to cut out the middleman, so a produce marketplace competes with everyone who has already tried and will not win here.

ONE ANSWER, NOT THE ANSWER A USSD, SMS, voice or chat line, in Kiswahili or English.

TRACK 3 **Kazi** Kabla ya Daktari

PROBLEM The patient has already diagnosed himself. He searched his symptoms at 2am, argued with a chatbot until it agreed with him, and arrives handing the nurse a verdict instead of a symptom.

GOAL Stop self-diagnosis turning into misdiagnosis, without replacing the clinician.

FIXED RULES Never “you may have”, the clinic stores nothing, and each session opens by saying AI is involved. Judges ask whether the clinician got a better starting point than they would have had. A team may swap the nurse for another professional (a pharmacist, a vet, a paralegal) only if that professional is on the team and in the room.

ONE ANSWER, NOT THE ANSWER A number the patient messages in the waiting room, four questions (what you searched, what it said, what you fear it is, what you actually feel), and a one-page note on the patient’s own phone to show the nurse.

Asks carried to Anthropic

Two findings are carried, not built. Both go to Anthropic’s Policy team in person at the Impact Lab on 2 September.

Pricing for purchasing power. A Max plan with tax costs about KES 27,000 a month. The gazetted minimum wage for a general labourer in Nairobi is reported as KES 18,047 under Legal Notice No. 109 of 2026, effective 1 May 2026 (press reports; gazette not independently checked). Alongside that, hardware inflation: 32 GB of DDR5 at KES 30,000, about four times last year’s price, and a 1 TB SSD at KES 35,000 to 40,000, roughly double what older stock sold for. The ask, in the room’s words, is to “adjust for purchasing power.”

Data terms. Who owns Kenyan data used for training? The room did not get as far as terms. The host’s proposal, which nobody voted on: a licence that the contributor can revoke, and no cloning of identifiable voices, which the room raised as a live fraud problem aimed at parents.

Next steps

ACTION	OWNER	DATE
Tracks blast to the approved builders	Peter Kibet	Before doors, 2 September 2026
Builders bring one question for Anthropic's team and one thing they want it to hear, for the 9:00 AM hour	Builders	2 September 2026
Put the pricing and data-terms asks to Anthropic's Policy team in person	Peter Kibet	2 September 2026
Photograph every 11:00 AM wall sheet before teardown at Hackhouse	Organising team	2 September 2026
Send this report to Anthropic's Community team	Peter Kibet	After 2 September 2026
Updated report with the wall photographs and the Impact Lab results	Peter Kibet	After 2 September 2026

Corrections welcome. Send them to Peter Kibet.